

Ideation Phase

Define the Problem Statements

Date	Oct 2 nd 2026
Team ID	6ab8c330c23107aaaa72e953
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Maximum Marks	

Project detail	Description
Project title	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Platform	ServiceNow (Import Sets, Transform Maps, Reports and Dashboards)
Team	5 members: a Team Lead and 4 team members
Customers	ServiceNow Administrator, HR Operations Executive, HR Manager

Customer Problem Statement Template:

A problem statement helps the team understand the customer's point of view. The Customer Problem Statement template focuses on five parts: who the customer is (I am), what they want to achieve (I'm trying to), what stands in their way (but), why it happens (because) and how it makes them feel (which makes me feel).

In this project, the customers are the people who depend on employee data in ServiceNow. Each of them faces a different problem when employee data arrives in an Excel spreadsheet. The three problem statements below describe those problems in detail and show how the project solves each one.

Who are our customers?

Customer	What they do	What they need
ServiceNow Administrator	Receives the employee file from HR and loads it into ServiceNow.	A fast, accurate and checkable way to import many records.
HR Operations Executive	Maintains the employee spreadsheet and sends updated versions.	Re-imports that update existing people instead of creating copies.
HR Manager	Tracks the workforce and reports team size to leadership.	A clear view of employees by department and location.

Problem Statements in Detail

PS-1: ServiceNow Administrator

PS-1 Customer: ServiceNow Administrator

I am	<i>Describe customer with 3-4 key characteristics - who are they?</i>	A ServiceNow administrator who receives bulk employee data from HR as an Excel file. I care about data quality and must load many records correctly and on time.
I'm trying to	<i>What outcome or "job" does the customer care about - what are they trying to achieve?</i>	Load all employee records (ID, name, email, department, location) from the spreadsheet into one ServiceNow table quickly and accurately.
but	<i>Describe what problems or barriers stand in the way - what bothers them most?</i>	Typing records one by one is slow, and loading a file straight into the live table risks wrong or messy data.
because	<i>Enter the "root cause" of why the problem or barrier exists - what needs to be solved?</i>	There is no staging area and no field mapping between the spreadsheet columns and the fields of the target table.
which makes me feel	<i>Describe the emotions from the customer's point of view - how does it impact them emotionally?</i>	Stressed and worried about making mistakes in company data.

Figure 1: Customer problem statement PS-1

Why it matters: Bulk employee data arrives as an Excel file. Entering 15 or more records by hand takes time and a single typing mistake spoils the company's employee records. Loading the raw file straight into the live table is just as risky, because bad rows go in with no check.

What the project does: The file is first loaded into a staging table (Import Set, u_employee_import). A Transform Map then matches each source field to a field of the target table (u_employee_test), and the administrator checks the result before relying on it (Phases 2 to 5).

PS-2: HR Operations Executive

PS-2 Customer: HR Operations Executive

I am	Describe customer with 3-4 key characteristics - who are they?	An HR operations executive who sends an updated employee file to the admin every time details change or new people join.
I'm trying to	What outcome or "job" does the customer care about - what are they trying to achieve?	Update changed details such as name or email, and add new joiners, by re-sending the same spreadsheet.
but	Describe what problems or barriers stand in the way - what bothers them most?	The same employee can appear twice, and the old record may stay wrong.
because	Enter the "root cause" of why the problem or barrier exists - what needs to be solved?	Records are not matched on a unique key such as Employee ID, so every import is treated as brand-new data.
which makes me feel	Describe the emotions from the customer's point of view - how does it impact them emotionally?	Frustrated and unsure whether the employee data can be trusted.

Figure 2: Customer problem statement PS-2

Why it matters: Employee details change all the time. When the same sheet is sent again with a new email or a corrected name, a system without a unique key creates a second copy of the employee and leaves the old record unchanged. The data soon becomes confusing and cannot be trusted.

What the project does: Coalesce is switched on for Employee ID. A new ID is inserted, an existing ID is updated, and an unchanged row is ignored. The test import showed 2 inserts and 2 updates, and importing the same file again gave 0 inserts, 0 updates and 4 ignored rows (Phases 6 and 7).

PS-3: HR Manager

PS-3 Customer: HR Manager

I am	Describe customer with 3-4 key characteristics - who are they?	An HR manager who tracks the workforce and reports team size to leadership.
I'm trying to	What outcome or "job" does the customer care about - what are they trying to achieve?	See how many employees are in each department and location at a glance.
but	Describe what problems or barriers stand in the way - what bothers them most?	The data is only available as raw rows, so I have to count and compare them by hand.
because	Enter the "root cause" of why the problem or barrier exists - what needs to be solved?	No reports or dashboard have been built on top of the employee table.
which makes me feel	Describe the emotions from the customer's point of view - how does it impact them emotionally?	Overwhelmed, and slower and less confident when making decisions.

Figure 3: Customer problem statement PS-3

Why it matters: Leaders ask simple questions such as how many people work in each department or location. If the answer needs manual counting, it takes longer and is easy to get wrong.

What the project does: Three reports are built on the Employee Test table (a pie chart by department, a bar chart by location and a list report). They are placed on one Employee Analytics Dashboard that can be shared with chosen users, groups and roles (Phases 8 and 9).

Problem Statements at a Glance

	I am	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	ServiceNow administrator	Load employee data from Excel into ServiceNow	Manual entry is slow and error-prone	No staging or field mapping step	Stressed and worried about mistakes
PS-2	HR operations executive	Update details and add new joiners by re-sending the sheet	The same employee gets created twice	Records are not matched on Employee ID	Frustrated, unsure the data is trustworthy
PS-3	HR manager	See employees by department and location	I have to count raw rows by hand	No reports or dashboard exist yet	Overwhelmed and slow to decide

Figure 4: The three problem statements side by side

Problem Statement Summary Table

Problem Statement (PS)	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	A ServiceNow administrator who receives bulk employee data from HR in Excel	Load all employee records from the spreadsheet into ServiceNow quickly and accurately	Typing records one by one is slow, and loading a file straight into the live table risks wrong data	There is no staging area and no field mapping between the spreadsheet and the target table	Stressed and worried about making mistakes in company data
PS-2	An HR operations executive who sends updated employee files	Update changed details and add new joiners by re-sending the same spreadsheet	The same employee can appear twice and the old record may stay wrong	Records are not matched on a unique key such as Employee ID	Frustrated and unsure whether the data can be trusted
PS-3	An HR manager who reports team size to leadership	See employees by department and location at a glance	The data is only raw rows, so I count and compare by hand	No reports or dashboard exist on the employee table	Overwhelmed, and slower and less confident when deciding

How the Project Solves Each Problem

Problem Statement (PS)	Project solution	How it solves the problem	Phases
PS-1	Import Set staging table and Transform Map	The file lands in u_employee_import first. The Transform Map moves the data into u_employee_test field by field, and the result is verified in the Employee Test table.	Phases 1 to 5
PS-2	Coalesce on Employee ID	New IDs are inserted, existing IDs are updated and unchanged rows are ignored, so no duplicate employees are created.	Phases 6 and 7
PS-3	Three reports and the Employee Analytics Dashboard	Pie chart by department, bar chart by location and a list report give a clear view of the employee data in one place.	Phases 8 and 9